

it? What keeps him motivated? "It takes drive and desire. That's the start. You have to want to excel," he said. "When you excel, you think in terms of being a leader, not a follower. And if you want to be a leader, you'll be willing to put the effort forward that's good old-fashioned drive, to compete and be number one," he told me.

Don firmly believes that being a self-starter is "a must" in direct sales. However, many people will disagree with him. Though it's an asset to be a self-starter, many are not. They get their "push" through motivation by talking to or learning from others. Don felt differently and it worked for him. He advises. "Don't wait for someone to show you how to do anything. Just go and do it! Learn from your mistakes, but do it. Then do your best. It doesn't matter if you want the excitement that comes from the money or moving ahead. Take a chance on yourself."

These days, he's at his office at five-thirty or six in the morning, often putting in an eleven- or twelve-hour day. Don has made a lifetime commitment to his career, getting satisfaction from his achievements while still setting and meeting new goals.

Don and other outstanding direct sellers share an understanding of the qualities it takes to achieve: persistence, energy, enthusiasm, goal-setting, and being self-starting. No one has actually come up with a formula describing the ideally successful salesperson. The formula will always vary because each one of us is unique—not only in terms of our strengths and weaknesses, but because of timing, location, and what we want. Also, we all don't aspire to being number one or number ten (or even number one hundred) in a company.

But *why* we want to achieve is another matter—and an individual one. Many of us need and crave recognition, and approval. Others are content with the more tangible rewards—high income, jewelry, cars, overseas trips—and might even shy away from public attention. Still others labor long and hard working for work's sake—they're intimately involved in being productive, needing to accomplish as much as they can in a lifetime. And yet